



How we Test

It looks good and the technology is glitzy, but does it do the job?

The Digital Media Test & Research Centre (DMTRC) conducts a series of elaborate tests to evaluate the merit of each hardware and software product. To ensure that our readers have all the information they need to make an informed buying decision, engineers at DMTRC evaluate and review the latest hardware, software and technology services in accordance with the most up-to-date evaluation processes and methodologies used around the world.

Comparison Tests

We use a dual rating system, the first of which is applied to the Comparison Tests in which we compare the performance of products within a particular category.

Each product is evaluated under different parameters such as performance, value for money, features, warranty and support, etc.

Weightages are then applied to the various test parameters according to their importance for that particular category of products.

These weightages are then used to arrive at an overall grade for each individual product. An overall grade of A+, therefore, indicates that the product is close to perfection.



The Awards

Digit awards outstanding products by selecting a Best Performance and Best Value winner in each comparison test. The winner of the Best Performance Award will be the product that scored the highest in the performance segment of our tests.

This award represents the best performing product in our tests and doesn't factor in any other parameter such as value for money, features, support, etc. The winner of the Best Value Award will be the product that scores the highest in our value for money parameter which is derived



taking into account the ratio of a product's performance and features to its price. The product winning this award offers good performance at a great price.

In Bazaar

The second part of the rating system is used to evaluate individual hardware and software products in the Bazaar section. The evaluation covers parameters such as performance, ease of use, value for money and the build quality/features of the product in question and then arrives at an overall rating.

Here each of these parameters is given a weightage of 25 per cent and is rated on a scale of 5, which is represented by arrows (▶).

The greater the number of arrows, the better the product. This simple five-point rating system is designed to give you an easy-to-interpret assessment of a product. For example, a product that receives an overall score of five arrows signifies an outstanding buy!

In Test this Month

Tring! Tring! Ok, so we all hate those loud ring tones but cell phones are increasingly assuming an integral part in our technology-driven lives. 35 of these consumables ring in their

charms within the busy walls of the Digit Test Centre. Nokia, Sony Ericsson, Siemens, Alcatel are all covered

in this comprehensive shootout. Ergonomic considerations such as grip; performance parameters such as voice clarity and ease of use; aspects relating to the user interface and features such as Bluetooth were all held firmly in mind while putting these gadgets through the paces.

Acer is the latest entrant in the Tablet PC market, with an 800 MHz processor and 256 MB of RAM. Is it a worthy addition? Find out in Bazaar.

Another neat little trinket is the optical mouse christened with a mouthful of a name—the SecuDesktop 2000 EyeD Optimouse. A digital camera from Olympus and a digital cam-

corder from Frontech also go under the magnifying glass. The latest version of McAfee VirusScan also makes an appearance, promising to offer security from

viruses, with new features such as HAWK to boot.

And there is more—a hard disk, a UPS, DVD burning software, a 4.1-speaker set, the works! Enjoy!



The 5-point Rating System used in Bazaar	
▶▶▶▶▶	Excellent: A brilliant combination of price, performance and features—far beyond expectations
▶▶▶▶▶	Good: A good buy, better than most products in its category
▶▶▶▶▶	Average: Reasonably competent but nothing spectacular about the product
▶▶▶▶▶	Mediocre: Does not live up to expectations, needs improvement in many areas
▶▶▶▶▶	Poor: has serious drawbacks and needs improvement before it can be used for its target application